Assignment 3 – Module 1: Plot Builder

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Objective

Practice plot development using cause-and-effect storytelling for film and game pre-production.

Instructions

Create either:

- A Short Film Idea
  OR
- A Video Game Idea

Story Title:

“Last Message”

Story Type:

Short Film Idea

1. Main Character Description

Aira is a young woman coping with the sudden death of her father. She is emotionally sensitive, grieving, and initially confused about her past relationship with him. She slowly becomes determined and curious as she tries to understand the truth behind his voice messages.

2. Main Plot

After her father’s death, Aira inherits his phone and begins receiving a series of scheduled voice messages he recorded before he passed away. At first, the messages feel like emotional comfort and guidance, helping her deal with grief. However, as she continues listening, the messages begin to reveal contradictions and hidden truths about her father’s life and their relationship. This pushes Aira into an emotional investigation where she must uncover what really happened between them, ultimately leading her to a painful revelation and personal closure.

3. Goal

Aira’s goal is to understand the meaning behind her father’s posthumous voice messages and uncover the hidden truth about their relationship.

4. Conflict

Aira receives scheduled voice messages from her deceased father, but they contain inconsistent memories and a hidden truth she is not ready to face. Her emotional struggle grows as she questions what is real, what was hidden, and whether she truly knew her father at all.

5. One Subplot

Aira's relationship with her mother is strained because her mother avoids talking about the father's past. This creates emotional tension and prevents Aira from getting answers directly, forcing her to rely only on the voice messages.

6. Six Cause-and-Effect Events

1. Aira's father passes away and she inherits his old phone
   ↓
2. She discovers a pre-recorded voice message that activates after his death
   ↓
3. She continues receiving scheduled messages that comfort her during emotional moments
   ↓
4. She notices contradictions in the messages that don't match her memories or her mother's silence
   ↓
5. Driven by suspicion, she argues with her mother and tries to uncover the truth but receives no answers, so she unlocks the final message early
   ↓
6. The final message reveals a painful truth about her father's past and the emotional distance between them

7. Ending

Aira learns the full truth behind her father's actions and understands that his love existed, but was expressed through flawed decisions. Though emotionally shaken, she forgives him, finds closure, and begins healing. In the final scene, she records her own voice message for her future self, accepting her grief and choosing to move forward with emotional maturity.

Submission Requirements

Submit:

- Story Title
- Story Type (Short Film or Video Game)
- Main Character Description
- Main plot
- Goal
- Conflict
- Subplot
- Six Cause-and-Effect Events
- Ending

Learning Outcomes

By completing this assignment, students will:

✔ Understand plot development

✔ Practice cause-and-effect storytelling

✔ Learn how subplots support the main narrative

✔ Improve pacing decisions

✔ Develop stronger stories for film, animation, and game pre-production